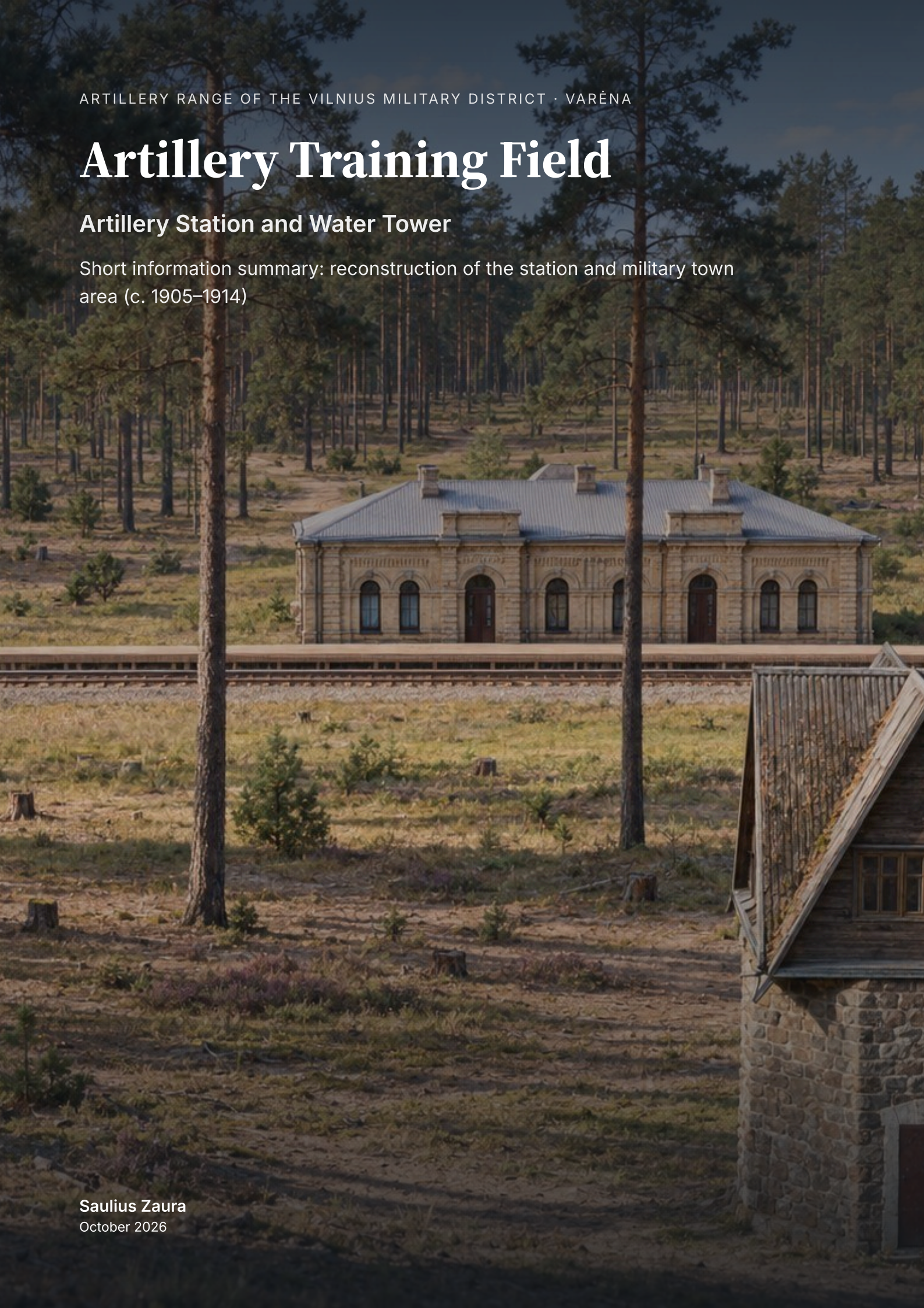
ARTILLERY RANGE OF THE VILNIUS MILITARY DISTRICT · VARĖNA

Artillery Training Field

Artillery Station and Water Tower

Short information summary: reconstruction of the station and military town area (c. 1905–1914)



Saulius Zaura
October 2026

About the site

In the late 19th and early 20th century, the summer camp of the Vilnius Military District artillery – an artillery training field – operated on the eastern bank of the Varėnė river. After the Varėna–Alytus railway branch was built in 1894, an Artillery Station with a platform for unloading guns and horses and a water tower for steam locomotives were built. The station and the tower survive; the officers' club, the Orthodox church and the barracks were lost and their sites are now forest.

The reconstruction is based on 2025 national LiDAR data (building outlines, railway embankment, platform, alleys), current-state 3D models, historical photographs and written sources, including the memoirs of M. Dobužinskis. Images marked “refined with AI tools” are renders of the 3D model whose materials and lighting were refined with auxiliary AI image-processing tools; the shapes were not changed.



Bird's-eye view of the area (refined with AI tools)

Former Artillery Station and water tower

A brick station (~28×10 m) with arched windows and a projecting entrance porch. Its roof is believed to have been sheet metal from the start. Next to it stands a water tower with an octagonal body, its entrance facing north-east; photographs from 1937 show its top as wooden, clad in vertical boards, with a sheet-metal roof. Historical photographs also show two camp buildings not included in the reconstruction: the staff building next to the officers' club and the flag pavilion by Lake Glūkas.



Current state. Photo S. Zaura



Water tower. Photo S. Zaura



Station and water tower, c. 1910 (refined with AI tools)

Military town

On the Varėnė bluff stood a two-storey brick officers' club (designed 1903) with a courtyard and fountain; further on, a wooden Orthodox church with a gate pavilion and a monument to Catherine II, log barracks and a birch alley.



Officers' club. Šiauliai “Aušra” Museum, ŠAM F-SF-1452



Synthesis of the reconstructed facade and the historical setting (refined with AI tools)

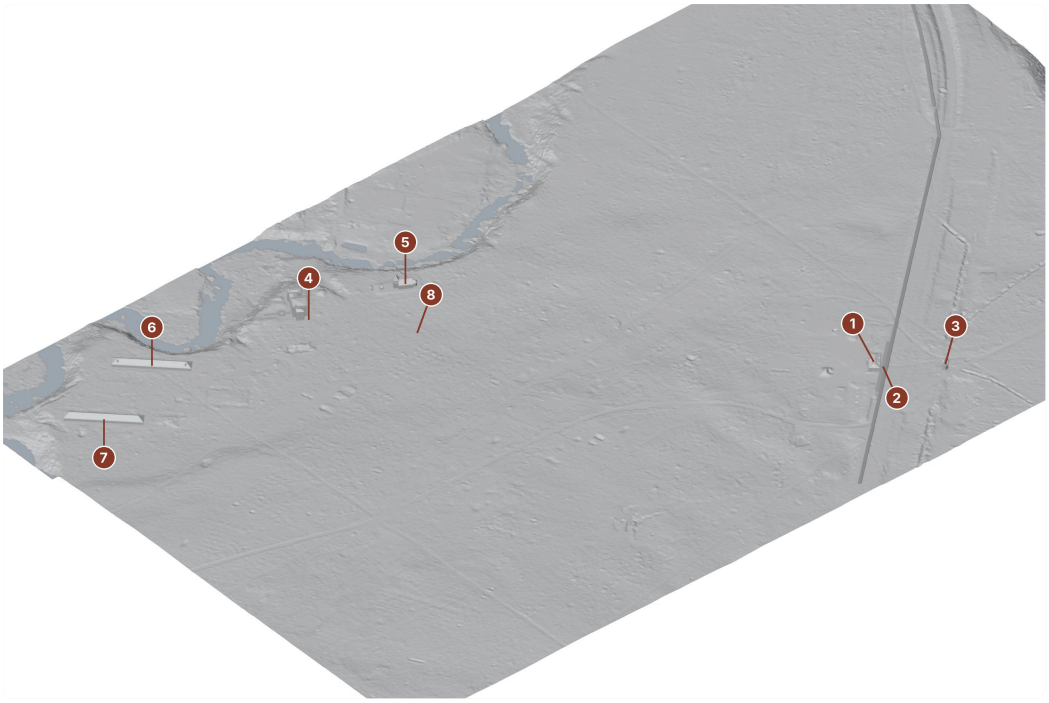


Church and monument. G. Jaronienė collection, Varėna District Public Library



Club on the bluff (refined with AI tools)

Reconstruction model and 3D models



Reconstruction model: 1 station, 2 platform, 3 water tower, 4 club, 5 church, 6–7 barracks, 8 birch alley

Whole area c. 1905–1914
skfb.ly/pOQFO

Former Artillery Station
skfb.ly/pDnoB

Water tower
skfb.ly/pB7MB

Officers' club 3D print model 1:200 – view
skfb.ly/pOQHC

Officers' club print kit – download
STL

Key dates

1877	General plan of the artillery range drawn up
1894	Varėna–Alytus railway branch built; Artillery Station with platform and water tower
1895	Camp general plan includes barracks, a church and an officers' club
1902–1903	Designs of the church and the brick officers' club
1915	Retreating Russian troops burned part of the buildings; Germans rebuilt some in 1915–1918
1919–1922	Camp handed over to Lithuania; about 560 wooden buildings still counted in 1922
1927–1944	State tuberculosis sanatorium in the officers' club; the building was blown up in 1944
Today	The former Artillery Station and water tower survive; other sites lie under forest, visible in LiDAR data

Visiting

The former Artillery Station stands at Grybautojų g. 8, Glūkas (Varėna district); the water tower is next to it at the forest-road junction. The ruin mound of the officers' club lies on the Varėnė bluff, about 650 m south-west of the station.

Saulius Zaura

Artillery Training Field. Artillery Station and Water Tower · 2026

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